

Post-incident review PIR-2025-060

Data Warehouse: partial outage

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 01 May 2025, Data Warehouse experienced partial outage in production (AU East) for about 40 minutes. A latency threshold alert fired for the service's main endpoint. Investigation found that one tenant's bulk import consumed most of the shared queue throughput.

Impact

Users of Data Warehouse saw partial outage for about 40 minutes. The service owner, Data Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:20 First signal received.
- 09:38 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:54 Likely cause identified.
- 10:04 Mitigation applied.
- 10:56 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that one tenant's bulk import consumed most of the shared queue throughput.

The team first suspected a recent configuration change, but the change log showed nothing relevant.

The rollback script had never been exercised and failed on first use.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

The change was made outside the approved maintenance window.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.